Operate like consultants, *prove it in Crelate*

Wed 21 Oct · 8:00–9:00
Kev leads · laptops at the table
Pillar 03 · Accountability

Why today. Clients buy RPO when they can see every job order being worked, and they keep paying when we show up with intel, not just résumés. Crelate is the proof; market knowledge is the edge.

1 · Crelate best practices

8:02 · 15 MIN

Laptops open. Use the Hub's Job Orders folder to see who's on what.

- **Activity to the right job:** this week's RPs, PTCs, screens and submittals are logged against the JO they were for. Re-link anything filed to the contact only.
- **One board standard:** same stage names in order, every candidate in exactly one stage, owner set, a next step with a date, and a why-submitted note on every submittal.
- **Name one fix** you'll finish by end of day. Nick audits the boards Friday.

THE RPO LINE

"Here's every JO, the activity on it this week, and where each candidate stands." If Crelate can't show it, it didn't happen.

2 · Precon vs estimating

8:17 · 12 MIN

	ESTIMATING	PRECONSTRUCTION
Job	Prices the drawings: takeoffs, sub bids, bid-day number	Shapes the project before drawings are done: budgets at SD/DD, VE, constructability, GMP
Stage	CDs, hard bid	Concept to GMP; CMAR and design-build
In the room	Subs and the PM	Owner, architect, ops leadership
Ladder	Estimator → Sr → Chief Estimator	Precon Mgr → Director → VP Precon
Scored on	Accuracy vs buyout, hit rate	Pursuit win rate, GMP holding

ASK ON THE CALL

"Do you build budgets from SD drawings or price hard-bid CDs?" · "Who's in the owner meetings?" · "GMP or lump sum?" A "precon manager" who only does takeoffs is an estimator.

3 · Become the consultant

8:29 · 12 MIN

Every client and candidate call carries one piece of intel and one piece of advice.

- **Bring a number:** backlog, labor, what titles are paying, who's hiring for data centers. One line, sourced.
- **Bring the map:** who's available, who just moved, who competitors are chasing. Your depth chart is your briefing.
- **Give a recommendation:** "If you open this to remote precon you'll double the pool," or "Your title reads estimator; call it Precon Manager and you'll reach the right people."

OPENER

"Before we get into the role, here's what we're seeing in your market this month…" Then stop and listen.

REP (5 MIN, PEN)

Write the 3-sentence intel brief you'll give your top client this week: one number, one observation, one recommendation.

4 · What the market is doing

8:41 · 12 MIN

52 ENR confidence index, Q3: slightly positive, down 2. GCs and CMs are the most confident group at 59; 33% expect the economy to weaken (up from 23%).

8.7 Months of backlog, ABC, September: up for the second month running. Data-center contractors average 11.3 months. Commercial and institutional backlog is at its highest since July 2025.

+57% Data-center construction spending, year over year (August). All other private nonresidential combined: −7.3%. Manufacturing: −22%.

42% of firms say worker shortages delayed projects. 58% say data centers are pulling skilled people away; 49% see wage pressure. About 70% are hit by tariffs.

WHAT WE'RE SEEING ON OUR DESKS

Mission-critical PM and PX demand (San Jose), South Florida GC growth, Texas field leadership, and mechanical precon and estimating (DC and Baltimore).

HOW WE SHARE IT

Use one number as a call opener today. Jenny drafts a short "3 numbers this month" client note and a LinkedIn post for Kev to approve.

Sources: ENR 3Q 2026 Cost Report (23 Sep); ABC Construction Backlog Indicator (released 13 Oct); AGC on spending data (Aug) and the AGC/NCCER 2026 Workforce Survey (Sep). Figures are from published summaries; check before quoting to a client.

5 · Wrap

8:53 · 5 MIN

☐ **Crelate:** my one board fix, done by end of day.

☐ **Consultant:** my intel line, used on a call today.

☐ **Market:** one new name or number I'll bring Friday.

The Name Game, *know the names, own the conversation*

5 minutes, pen only
Use it Friday as the warm-up
or at the end of a Power Hour

Why it makes us better conversationalists. Credibility on a call comes from specifics. "I just spoke with [name], who runs precon at [firm], about [project]" earns the next question; "I work with a lot of GCs" doesn't. Fill in your market from memory first, then check the depth chart and fill the gaps in a second colour. The gaps are your homework.

My market

NAME IT:

TOP 5 FIRMS I RECRUIT FROM	PRECON OR OPS LEADER THERE	ONE LIVE PROJECT

WHO JUST MOVED (AND WHERE)

My client

NAME IT:

PEOPLE WHO DECIDE	WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT THIS QUARTER

THEIR THREE BIGGEST COMPETITORS FOR TALENT

ONE NAME I'LL DROP ON A CALL TODAY, AND WHY IT MATTERS TO THEM

Rules: no comp, no private details, no client names in front of other clients. Names and roles only. A name you can't place in a project doesn't count.